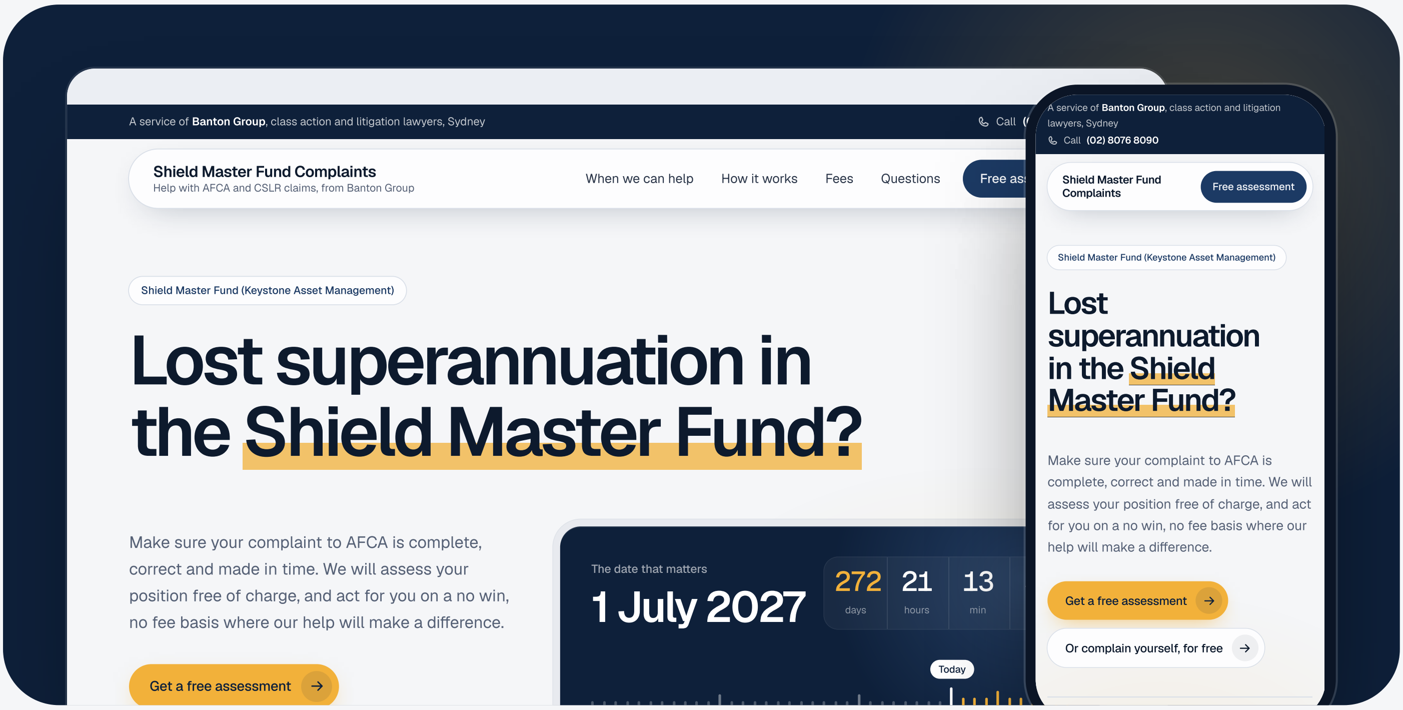
KEYSTONE (4696)

Mock-up for approval

Shield Master Fund Complaints website

A standalone claims site operated by Banton Group. Not live. Prepared 30 September 2026.



A service of **Banton Group**, class action and litigation lawyers, Sydney

Call

Shield Master Fund Complaints
Help with AFCA and CSLR claims, from Banton Group

When we can help · How it works · Fees · Questions · Free as

Shield Master Fund (Keystone Asset Management)

Lost superannuation in the Shield Master Fund?

Make sure your complaint to AFCA is complete, correct and made in time. We will assess your position free of charge, and act for you on a no win, no fee basis where our help will make a difference.

Get a free assessment →

The date that matters

1 July 2027

272	21	13
days	hours	min

Today

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How the site is pitched

A standalone Shield site, one of two campaign streams (the other is First Guardian). It is built for the Shield cohorts: Macquarie investors whose capital was repaid, Equity Trustees investors who have not been repaid, and MWL and InterPrac clients.

It leads with the fact that AFCA is free and that investors can complain themselves, with links to AFCA and the ASIC-funded Take Your Super Back tool. That matches what ASIC and AFCA tell investors, and it is what separates us from claims agents.

It then sets out the eight situations where our help is most likely to change the outcome, and the 1 July 2027 date that matters for CSLR.

Fees: free assessment; no win, no fee; nothing upfront; a fixed fee of $5,000 including GST, payable only from compensation received.

It carries a scam warning, a factual list of the class actions already filed, and a short intake form that feeds Formstack and Actionstep.

What follows

Page 2	The full page as it would appear on a desktop browser.
Page 3	The same page on a mobile phone.

Open before launch

- ☐ Form of the conditional costs agreement and costs disclosure.
- ☐ Domain name, hosting, privacy collection statement and terms of use.
- ☐ Compliance read of all copy against r 36 of the Australian Solicitors' Conduct Rules 2015 and the Australian Consumer Law before any advertising runs.
- ☐ Facts on the “What has happened with Shield” panel to be refreshed on launch day.

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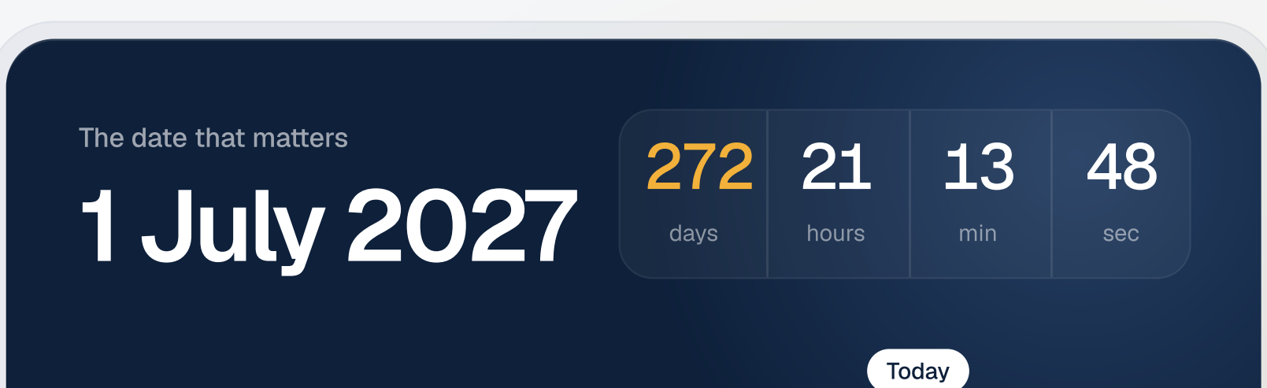
- Free assessment
- Nothing to pay upfront
- No win, no fee

The date that matters

1 July 2027

272	21	13	48
days	hours	min	sec



If your adviser's business has collapsed, the Compensation Scheme of Last Resort can pay an AFCA award up to $150,000. For investors whose capital Macquarie has repaid, the Scheme has said it will generally not cover the lost returns that remain on complaints made on or after 1 July 2027. For many Macquarie investors, lost returns are most of what is left.

Source: CSLR, Shield and First Guardian resources, 10 September 2026. The Government has also proposed limiting Scheme payments to actual losses for complaints made after 30 June 2027.

$0

You can complain to AFCA yourself, and it is free

AFCA does not charge you, and you do not need a lawyer to use it. ASIC has funded a free online tool to help you prepare a complaint. If your situation is straightforward, we will tell you so and point you to these resources rather than act for you.

`afca.org.au`
Australian Financial Complaints Authority ↗

`takeyoursuperback.com`
Take Your Super Back ↗

Some complaints are not straightforward

These are the situations where a lawyer is most likely to change the outcome for Shield investors. If one of them applies to you, ask us for a free assessment.

01

Macquarie repaid your capital

You may still be owed the returns you would have earned in your old fund. AFCA has awarded these even after Macquarie's repayment.

02

You invested through Equity Trustees

Members of AMG Super and Super Simplifier have not been repaid. ASIC is suing the trustee, but that case will not be heard before 2027.

03

Your adviser was with MWL

MWL Financial Services is in liquidation. If AFCA decides in your favour, the Compensation Scheme of Last Resort can pay, up to $150,000.

04

You were advised through InterPrac

AFCA has paused decisions on InterPrac complaints while InterPrac's court case against AFCA runs. We keep your complaint on track.

05

More than one adviser or platform

Every responsible firm needs to be identified and included in your complaint, or you may leave compensation behind.

06

You used an SMSF

Your fund is the complainant, and the cost of winding up the SMSF can form part of the claim.

07

Your loss is over $150,000, or you lost insurance

The Scheme's cap is $150,000, and life, TPD or trauma cover lost on the switch can be part of the claim. We look at what else can be recovered.

08

You are in a class action or offered a deed

We check how the Macquarie class action affects your complaint, and whether any deed or settlement asks you to give up other rights.

What has happened with Shield

Last updated 29 September 2026. Sources: ASIC, AFCA and CSLR publications and court records.

FEBRUARY 2024

ASIC stops new investment

ASIC made interim stop orders halting new offers of Shield.

JUNE TO AUGUST 2024

Assets frozen, receivers appointed

The Federal Court froze Shield's assets and appointed receivers. Keystone has since gone into liquidation.

AUGUST 2025

ASIC sues Equity Trustees

ASIC is suing Equity Trustees over about $160 million invested in Shield, seeking compensation for members.

SEPTEMBER 2025

Macquarie repays capital

Macquarie repaid about $321 million invested in Shield by its members, less withdrawals.

JUNE 2026

ASIC sues Keystone's directors

ASIC alleges about $305 million was moved to related entities without proper safeguards.

NOW

AFCA and the Scheme

AFCA is deciding complaints against most advisers, but InterPrac complaints are paused until at least February 2027, and the Scheme is waiting for funding.

How it works

Five steps

1. **Tell us about it**
   Complete the form and upload any statements, advice documents or letters you have.
2. **Free assessment**
   We tell you whether you need us. If you do not, we say so and point you to free help.
3. **We prepare your complaint**
   If we act, we identify every responsible firm and prepare and lodge your complaint with AFCA.
4. **We deal with AFCA**
   We respond to the firms and to AFCA and check AFCA's loss calculation.
5. **The Scheme, if needed**
   If your adviser cannot pay, we make your claim to the Compensation Scheme of Last Resort.

No win, no fee

Nothing to pay upfront.

- **Free** initial assessment.
- A **fixed fee of $5,000, including GST**, agreed in writing before we start.
- Payable **only from compensation** you receive. If you receive nothing, you pay nothing.
- You have **five business days** to change your mind after signing.

What you are paying for

AFCA and the Compensation Scheme of Last Resort do not charge you. Our fee is for our work on your complaint, not for access to AFCA.

Where a complaint is complex, we will ask AFCA to order the financial firm to contribute to your legal costs. AFCA usually caps a contribution at $5,000 and does not always make one. Any contribution reduces what you pay us.

We only take on a complaint where the likely compensation is well above our fee. Before you sign anything we will give you a written costs agreement and disclosure explaining the fee, when it is payable and your rights.

Class actions already filed

Other law firms have started these class actions against Macquarie. We are not acting in them. If you are a group member, we will check how it affects your complaint. No class action has been filed for Equity Trustees members.

S ECI 2026 06235

Dessent v Macquarie Investment Management Ltd

Court	Supreme Court of Victoria
Law firm	Gordon Legal
Who it covers	Macquarie Superannuation Plan members who invested in Shield between 1 March 2022 and 5 June 2023

QUD425/2026

Buttigieg v Macquarie Bank Limited

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Who it covers	The applicant has applied to discontinue this proceeding

Current at 29 September 2026, from court records and the firms' published information.

Beware of recovery scams

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First name	Last name
Email	Mobile
Platform or super fund Macquarie, Equity Trustees,	Adviser or licensee MWL, InterPrac, FSGA, UGC,
Amount invested (approximate) $	Has Macquarie repaid your capital? Select
Complained to AFCA already? Select	Invested through an SMSF? Yes / No

Anything else we should know

Upload statements, statements of advice or letters (optional)

☐ I agree to Banton Group contacting me about my investment and complaint.

☐ I have read the Privacy Collection Statement.

Send for free assessment →

Common questions

Do I need a lawyer to complain to AFCA?

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272 days
21 hours
13 min
45 sec

Today

Feb 2024
1 Jul 2027

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Adviser or licensee
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$

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